

these are the people that we often struggle most to confide in, because there is more at stake.

It messes with the power dynamic

Power dynamics in relationships fascinate me, and they are a topic in and of themselves, but what I have spent a long time paying particular attention to is how they are affected when money arises in conversation. Healthy interpersonal relationships usually have a power dynamic that is equal, or fairly close to equal as a baseline – and often we don't want to bring money into it, in case it alters things. This can, in turn, make our relationships more difficult to manage, or lead to awkwardness between friends or family members with different financial situations.

It's not only in our personal relationships that the money-power dynamic has an effect. I recently spoke as part of a panel on the topic of money and work, called 'Should you let your boss into your bank account?' One of the topics I was keen to table was the sensitivity of discussing money at work, because although the employer-employee relationship pivots on the fact that we all go to work in order to get paid, it's probably the place where we're least comfortable discussing personal finance issues. Having been through an awkward stage at a previous job, where the non-materialization of a promised pay rise made things even more difficult in my finances, I wanted to talk about the currents of power in